

The pasuk could have said (2:3) וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתוֹ כִּי בּו שְׁבַת מְכַל מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים לַעֲשׂוֹת. What does the word לַעֲשׂוֹת add? רש"י says on the pasuk before מְנוּחָה. He brings from the medrash מְנוּחָה, בָּאת שְׁבַת בָּאת מְנוּחָה, בָּאת שְׁבַת בָּאת מְנוּחָה. An interesting concept. We think of מְנוּחָה as the absence of work. So how is it called a בְּרִיאָה? We have to redefine and reunderstand what the word מְנוּחָה means, vis-a-vis the הקדוש ברוך הוא. Now, we know that the ששת ימי בראשית are different from all the rest of history in that each and every day הוא הקדוש ברוך הוא created something which had not been there before, it's a Latin term, creatio ex nihilo, the term that we're more familiar with is יום מאין. During ששת ימי בראשית, Hashem created all of the contents of the world that had never been there before.

Beginning with Shabbos, הוא הקדוש ברוך הוא recreates everything in the world each and every day, יום מאין. All the ספרים bring down that the הקדוש ברוך הוא is הנמצא כל מציא - ממציא ברוך הוא, בכל רגע ורגע, causes the existence of all matter in this world. The exact opposite of Aristotle who said matter is eternal, we say that matter is the הקדוש ברוך הוא's creation each and every moment, and not only that, it's יום מאין. Just because it was there before, the previous moment's existence is absolutely no reason for this matter, this particle of matter to be there the next second. Each and every moment, the world is being recreated. We say that in davening every single day, הַמְחִדֵּשׁ בְּטוֹבוֹ בְּכָל יוֹם תָּמִיד מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית. What does that mean? הַמְחִדֵּשׁ בְּטוֹבוֹ - the הקדוש ברוך הוא is newly creating; תָּמִיד - continuously; מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית. So, שבת, which we use as a symbol of resting, of stopping from work, is actually our עדות, is our testimony that הוא הקדוש ברוך הוא is the ממציא and the בורא העולם and continues its constant existence. As the בית הלוי, which this is from, says, we are used to seeing things continually existing because in our minds, in our eye, we see things being there on a constant basis. That's because we can't see it being recreated every second. הוא הקדוש ברוך הוא made it that way. In our mind and in our consciousness, that's called מְנוּחָה. That's called שבת, it's called resting. Hashem is recreating the world every second - that is מְנוּחָה. ששת ימי בראשית was creating something which had never been there before - that's called בְּרִיאָה.

The בית הלוי is explaining that רש"י is saying that when Hashem made שבת, it's a symbol of מְנוּחָה, that Hashem is actually the ongoing מְנוּחָה and בורא העולם forever. That's what לַעֲשׂוֹת means - that Hashem's act of creation wasn't something finished, but something that continues; creation was made "לַעֲשׂוֹת", to be ongoing, constantly renewed. That is a tremendous concept. I understand the great גדולים knew this, appreciated it, and kept it in their minds constantly. We of a lesser stature have to be reminded of it at least once a year in פרשת בראשית. It's a good thing to remember. הוא הקדוש ברוך הוא is תָּמִיד הַמְחִדֵּשׁ בְּטוֹבוֹ בְּכָל יוֹם תָּמִיד. It's a great thing to be able to keep in mind, relearn, and emphasize.

